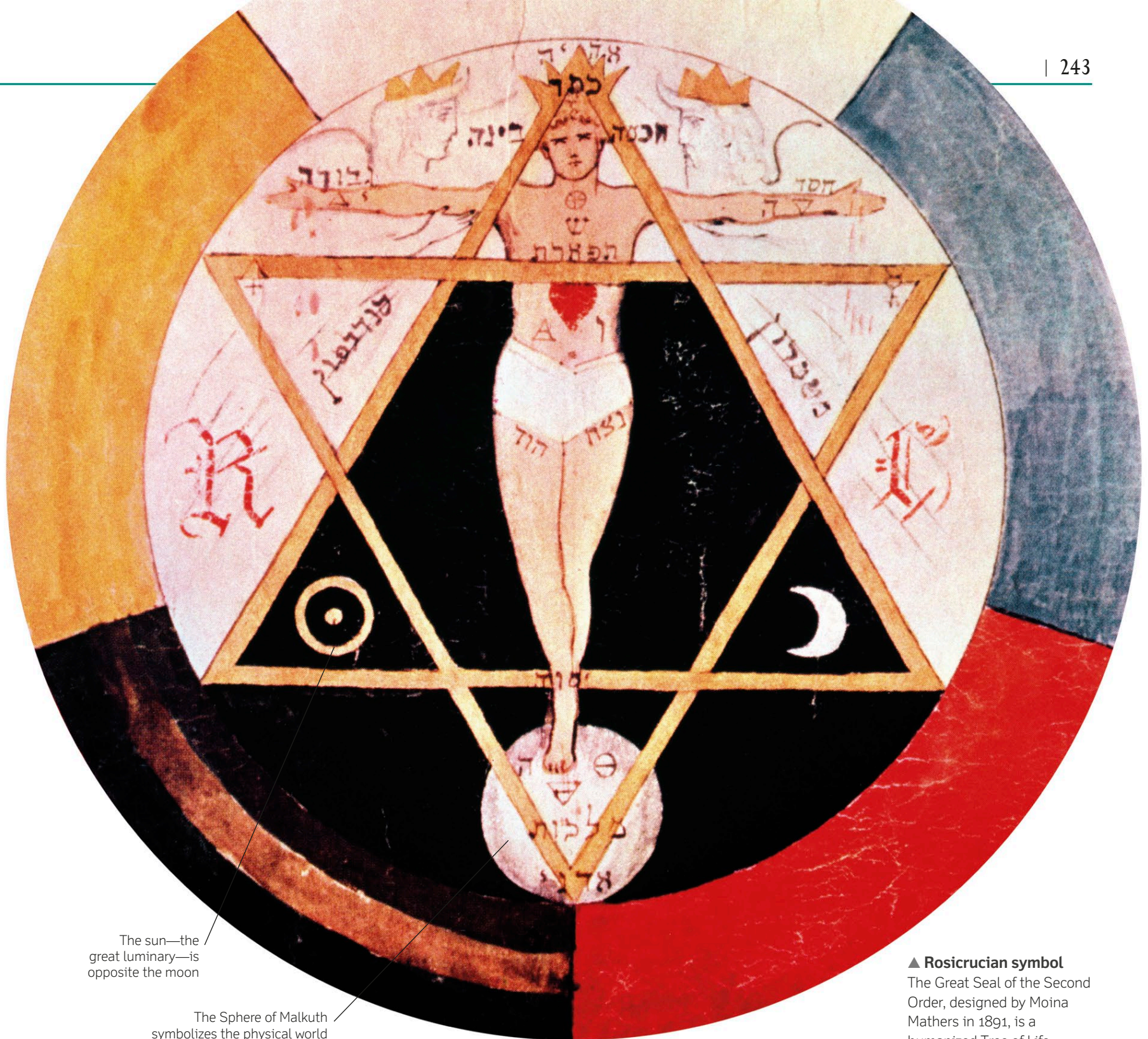




The sun—the great luminary—is opposite the moon

The Sphere of Malkuth symbolizes the physical world

▲ Rosicrucian symbol

The Great Seal of the Second Order, designed by Moina Mathers in 1891, is a humanized Tree of Life. The central figure within a pentagram is supported by archangels; the outer bands represent the elements: water, fire, earth, air, and spirit.

(see pp.136–139). The first sphere was a psychic world called the Golden Dawn; practical magic began in the second (the Red Rose and the Cross of Gold); and the third was the world of the divine (the Secret Chiefs).

Decisive women

The Order of the Golden Dawn appealed to a privileged and artistic group. Unusually for the time, it regarded men and women as equal; the contributions of its female members had

a significant influence over this new world of high magic. Male members included authors Bram Stoker and Arthur Conan-Doyle and the poet W.B. Yeats, while the Order's women included theater patron Annie Horniman, who pioneered the British repertory movement; Irish revolutionary Maud Gonne; actress Florence Farr; and painter Moina Bergson, who married founder Samuel Mathers in 1890 and later became high priestess of the Order. With its remarkable members, the Order kept going until the 1970s.